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No subject has been neglected as has been the *unio mystica*, or the union of the believer with Christ. The theologians of the Reformation saw it and found it precious, but they did not work it out. They were too occupied in their struggle against Rome. Rationalism was spiritually altogether too sterile and intellectualistic as to lay hold on this blessed truth.

Not until we come to modern times do we find that this marvelous truth, redolent with heaven's fragrance, has became the object of study and research. This union which is a hallowed oneness lies as the rock bottom of all the soteriological truths and further is the basis of all Christian ethics and conduct as well. This union we want to examine here briefly.

This union is *not found in the Old Testament.*

There is a remarkable union of God with Israel as a marriage relation. Israel is compared time again to the wife of Jehovah by virtue of the covenant relation between God and His earthly people. Especially Jeremiah and Hoseah refer to this intimate relation time and again. Israel broke through idolatry and other sins this marriage relation, and is now as a wife forsaken and desolate, Isa. 54: 1, Hos. 3:2-5. However, apart from this real covenant relation, all the expressions of unity as that of the Lord as a rock and refuge, tower and pavilion for His own are poetic pictures to express the fact that all that trust in God are safe and secure, but these and other phrases do not mean to bring out any essential and mystical union of Israel with God.

There are in the second place also marvelous foreshadowings of a future hiding in the Savior as the hiding place for a poor sinner. The very first type of the sin covering Adam and Eve, practically assured them that they would hide in the Lamb for sinners to be slain. The second great type of the ark was also a type of Christ as the only hiding place in the devastating storm and the billows of the judgment of a holy God. The standing type of the cities of refuge preached the same blessed truth of safety from destruction for all that flee to Him for refuge. The mountains round about Jerusalem also adumbrate Christ protecting His people by day and by night, and likewise the angel of the Lord, encamping round about those that fear Him. Nevertheless all these rich types together did not delineate the realistic oneness of the Lord with His own such as we now enjoy.

The Characteristics of this Union

This union is altogether *unique.* In all marital, moral, and covenantal unions there is not one union like unto this oneness of the risen Lord with the believers. All human unions are breakable and are broken with death, whereas this union is inviolable and eternal. It is even compared to the co-interexistence of the Persons in the Godhead. Even death cannot break this union. This union is a *mutual* inbeing

of Christ and the believers, He being in them and they in Him, John 15:5; 17:21; the former denoting their standing and the latter the state of the believers. This union is an *eternal* union, because they have been chosen in Him before the foundation of the world, Eph. 1:4, 5. This includes a) on the part of the Father the eternal choice and appointment of the Son to be our Surety and Substitute, and we hear the Father say: "Behold my servant whom I uphold, Mine elect in whom My soul delights," Isa. 42:1 -- "I have laid help upon a mighty one: I have exalted a chosen one out of the people," Ps. 89:19 - "Who hath saved us, according to his own purpose and grace given us in Christ Jesus before the world began," II Tim. 1:9. b) God also had to choose a people for His Son, and we read that He has "from the beginning chosen you to salvation," II Thess. 2:13; Matt. 11:25; 24:22; Luke 10:20; John 13:18; 15:16; Rom. 8:28-39; 9:11; 12:4 ; I Cor. 2:1, 26; Eph. 1:4-11; I Thess. 1:2; I Peter 1:1. c) On the part of the Son this meant a complete willingness from eternity to become the Surety of His own, Ps. 40:78; Heb. 10:5-7.

This union is a *federal* union.

This union was constituted between the Father and the Son in the covenant of peace. Especially Reformed theologians have always believed that there was such a covenant or mutual understanding between the Father and the Son in behalf of the elect. When entering upon His public duties among Israel our Savior time and again alluded to such a pact of peace between the Father and Himself. He came not to do His own will but the Father's will. He did not speak His own word, and His own doctrine but that of His Father. Seven times in His High Priestly prayer He refers to those given Him by His Father. "All, that the Father giveth me shall come unto me," John 6:37. He finished the work the Father gave Him to do, and He glorified the Father on the earth, and in all His burdensome work He had the opened ear and He could say: "I was not rebellious," Isa. 50:5.

Christ was not like His type Jonah, the prophet, who ran away and went northwest over sea, when he had to go northeast by land. Christ wanted to do what the Father gave Him to do.

This union is *forensic* and not merely ethico-mystical. By forensic we mean that God judicially imputes all that Christ does to the believers. In time He joins them to the Lord in the way of the new creation and faith. He joins them to Christ as members of His body and He thereby officially dissolves the federal connection that existed between them and the first Adam. This is clearly driven home to the believers in Rom. 7:1-5. He opens their heart as He did with Lydia that they give heed to the Word of and about the Savior. Just as God reckoned the old humanity judicially in the old Adam, so He likewise reckons judicially the new humanity in the new and last Adam. The principle of divine justice is the same in both cases.

This union is a *vital* and *vitalizing* union.

Believers have the eternal life which is in the Son, Rom. 8:10; Gal. 4:19; II Cor. 5:17; I John 3:24. This holy union is the governing factor of the Church as a whole and of every believer individually. Without Him they can do nothing, and contrariwise, with Him they can do all things, who strengthens them, or as Godbey has translated, who fills them up with dynamite. Believers are often powerless

because they fail to realize by faith this wondrous union. This is a vital truth and fact for the whole life and for all the practical ends of the Christian life.

Christ is not only the origin, bestower, keeper, strengthener, and regulator of our life, but He is our *Zoe,* our life, which is hid with Him in God, Col. 3:3, 4. His life is also the light of men, John 1:4, and the liberty, Rom. 8:2. This life can never die, John 11:25, 26, and since Christ is the resurrection and life, believers have the surest ground of confidence that our dead shall live again, John 14:19.

This is a *spiritual* union in that all that are joined to the Lord are one spirit, I Cor. 6:17. Christ is in heaven, and the saints are on earth, and yet they are inseparably and eternally one. The human mind cannot fathom this mystery, but childlike faith can easily grasp it. As Col. 3:3, 4 brings out, it is for the present a hidden union, but in the future day of His appearing it shall be publicly revealed. The word *Phaneroo* points to a public manifestation which can be seen by all the world of men, angels, and devils. No newspaper of the world has ever displayed one solitary news item about this most remarkable union, because it is a spiritual, invisible union, mediated and interposed by the Spirit of Christ. Hence it is called a unity of the Spirit, Eph. 4:1-4.

Though a spiritual union it is at the same time a real union. Many like to evaporate or at least greatly weaken this union into a figurative union such as there are found in the Old Testament, but we are not merely likened to the members of His body but we are in reality the spiritual members of His spiritual Body. We are not compared to His Body, but we are His Body, Eph. 1:22, 23; 5:30. We are flesh of His flesh, bones of His bones. This oneness is so real that it gives to the Church the right to the name of Christ, I Cor. 12:12. The union is absolute, real, and realistic, and may be called an identification, provided it is not taken in a pantheistic sense of the deification of man.

It is an *organic* union. The union between a monarch and his subjects forms an exclusively judicial union, which is outward and only temporal, but such is not the union between Him and His own. All who glorify Him as King and the members of His Body as His subjects have externalized this sacred union. He is the Head of this united Body, suggesting life, sympathy, control, regulation, care, thinking, planning, keeping, and burden-bearing, since in the East the burdens are borne upon the head. As surely as He was the Sin-bearer on Calvary, so certainly He is now the Burden-bearer of His people, carrying them with all their burdens. All the senses, lacking one, are in the head. The physical head is the seat of thought, sight, hearing, taste, speaking. The head holds the brain and main nerve-center and is the central station from which the whole personality is directed, ruled, guided, dominated, and thus Christ is the Governing Head of the Body not only, but as the glorious Head over all principality and power, Col. 2:10, as well, sees to it that all things work harmoniously together for the good of those who love God and have been called according to His purpose, Rom. 8:28; Eph. 1:21-23; 4:1 -5, 15, 16; 5:19,20.

It is also a *personal* union between Christ and every believer directly. The mystery of Corinth already abused this in Paul's day when they used this as a party cry, saving: "We are of Christ," as if all believers were not of Christ. Mystic females have

sometimes degraded this union in a sordid love affair, using thereby the Song of Solomon to cover their carnal love, but abuse never takes away the right use; It is a glorious tact that every believer is personally united to the Lord of glory; not only to a divine Lord, but also to the man Christ Jesus. The right use of this blessed truth we see especially in Paul who lived in the Lord, labored in the Lord, rejoiced in the Lord, bore the bonds of the Lord, greeted in the Lord, loved in the Lord, and expected to die in the Lord.

It is a liberating union. If believers now want to know whether they are under the law they need only seriously ask if Christ their Head, with Whom they are in perfect and indissoluble union, is under the Mosaic law, and then they will find that He was made under the law, Gal. 4:4, but that His crucifixion and resurrection changed all this forever far Him and all that by faith are united to Him. Again, if believers want to know whether they are still under rites and ritualism, then they can know that Gad has put all things under His feet in heaven, Eph. 1:22, though Israel on earth does not see this yet, Heb. 2:8. Being one with this exalted Lord of glory, we have in Him all rites and ritualisms under our feet. Once more, if believers want to know whether they should be buried with Christ in a watery grave, they must know that the risen Lord never went into a watery grave, never went under the element still under the curse and full of dismal germs, and that believers have been raised with Him in newness of life, Rom. 6:5-14; Col. 2:13, 20; 3:12. Who ever heard of resurrected folk being put in a watery grave. Our christendom is full of legalisms, dark passions, and turbid waters, because this holy union with the risen Lord is not known. Adventism, Mormonism, and many other isms could not flourish one single day, if this union of the believers with Christ were well understood.

This union leads inevitably to a four-fold *communion*: with the Father, with the Son, and with all believers, through, or in, the Spirit. Our fellowship is with the Father and with His Son, I John 1:3; the communion of the Holy Ghost, II Cor. 13:14; Phil. 2:1; John 14:23. Believers have, more or less, love for the saints and are to pray for all the saints, Eph. 6:18. This sacred union is the basis for the communion, and communion always implies reciprocal action from the other party to me and from me to the other party. The union denotes the standing, unalterable, indissoluble, eternal, whereas the communion has reference to the changeable state of the believer which can easily be broken by carnality, worldliness, prayerlessness, or some form of sin of omission or of commission.

This is a *resurrection*-union, by which we mean that it was not made with Jesus of Nazareth at His incarnation. Then it would be a Jewish union, since Christ was a minister of circumcision, a deacon of the Jews, in His personal ministry on earth as we are assured in Rom. 15:8; and since He was made under the law, Gal. 4:4, 5, it would be then a legalistic union, to do, with Him, the Mosaic law. It would then be an old Adamic union inasmuch as our Lord was forensically regarded and treated as the old Adam in the days of His flesh. This union would then belong to the old and not to the new creation; but as it was, the old creation was officially crucified and buried, whilst the new creation arose from the empty tomb with the risen Savior. This union does not commence with the incarnation, but with the cross and the resurrection of our Lord.

It is an *all-embracive* union, since the believers were crucified with Him, 6:4. All were buried once with Him and the risen ones should certainly not be buried again, Rom. 6:1-4. They were quickened, or made alive together by Him, Eph. 2:5; planted together with Him, Rom. 6:5; raised up together with Him, Eph. 2:5; Col. 3:1; seated together in the heavenlies with Him, Eph. 2:5: are now fitly framed together with Him, 2:21: suffering with Him, Rom. 8:17; Phil. 3:10; they live with Him, Gal. 2:20; are complete in Him, Col. 2:10; shall soon appear with Him in glory, Col. 34, and shall reign as kings with Him, Rom. 6:8; 8:17; II Tim. 2:12. This eternal union, which becomes an objective reality in His death and resurrection, and a subjective personal reality by faith in Christ, is all-comprehensive in that it covers the whole life of the believer and every believer.

It is an *interminable* union which shall last forever, stretching from eternity to eternity. Lack of grasping the indissolubility of this union has filled the land with senseless questions whether a true believer can fall away and be forever lost. Paul's song of eternal security in Rom. 8:35-39 is based upon the love of God which is *"in Christ Jesus, our Lord."* Take this last clause away, and his whole pean of victory becomes hollow braggadocio. This bond of union is as unbreakable as the indissoluble oneness of the Father and the Son, John 17:21-23. There is no perseverance of the saints, strictly speaking, because the saints on their part do not always persevere, but are often unfaithful and deny Him like Peter; but there is absolute perseverance on the part of the Father and the Son and the Holy Spirit, and since our life is hid with Christ in God, and He is our *Zoe,* our life, nothing in heaven, earth, or hell, can ever separate us from the love of God. In the light of this interminable and irrefragable union, all dispute and debate about eternal security has no sense, because they are debating the undebatable. Christ, our life, cannot be lost. Col. 3:4. The communion can be broken, not the union. Believers can loose at least seven things: their joy, their peace, their power for service, their fruitfulness, their position of witness in the church on earth, their opportunity of service, and their future reward of grace, and in this sense; become a castaway, I Cor. 9:27; and in this sense also a weak brother can perish, I Cor. 8:11. He perishes as worker in the church completely, but even so Christ is his life, and hence he cannot perish forever. If he were forever to perish, then Christ, his life, would have to perish. Paul would not call him a brother, if he were not in Christ, and as such safe and secure.

It is the most *effective* and *consequential* union, transforming the lives of the believers. The communion of the saints is based upon this union. Are they called to serve, then they become at once fellow-laborers in the Gospel, Phil. 1:3, 4; 4:3, 4, 15, is; fellow-helpers, III John 8, though some seem more hinderers than helpers, like Diotrphes of old, who forgot that Christ and not mortal man is to be pre-eminent: fellow-citizens, Eph. 2:19, all having the *politeuma,* or citizenship in heaven, Phil. 3:20, 21; fellow-heirs, Eph. 3:6; Rom. 8:17; fellow-servants; Col. 1:8 ; 4:7, 12; Rev. 22:9; fellow-soldiers, Eph. 6:11-15; Phil. 2:25; Philem. 2; fellow-prisoners, Philem. 1; Col. 4:12; Phil. 2:25. It can never be over-emphasized that this union rules and regulates every detail of a believer's life, just as the natural head completely governs the several members of the body, and it is the head which causes the separate members to cooperate harmoniously. The hands always wash each other and they

never fight or try to harm one another, and thus is it to be in the mystical Body of Christ.

It is an *exclusive* union in that it excludes all the unsaved. To base this union upon the incarnation as many of the mediating theologians in Germany, and also the Mercersburg theology, did, and then to apply this union to all mankind is utterly unscriptural. It includes *the* Christ I Cor. 12:12 the risen Lord and all that have been accepted in the Beloved, Eph. 1:6, the new and not the old humanity. It further excludes all that has been imposed by the law, Heb. 9:10, because in a Body the law does not sway but life and love. It excludes all the carnal ordinances, because these were abolished; blotted out, Col. 2:14. Israel had many carnal ordinances imposed upon them, Luke 1:6; Heb. 9:1, 10. It also excludes all formalism, ritualism, traditionalism. The Body of Christ is not and cannot be under the law. Since believers are with their bodies in the state and society, they are called to submit to all ordinances of men for conscience and for Christ's sake, but they are under the beneficent sway of the queen that is called grace, Rom. 6:14. This wondrous union with the Lord of glory also excludes the whole Pentecostal regime with all its signs and miracles of tongues, healings, raisings, angel visits and miraculous earthquakes. All the modern meetings held for the seeking of the Pentecostal baptism and the fire baptism, and the gift of the tongues, and the power of healing have only been fit opportunities for the enemy to counterfeit the work of God, run counter to the Word of God, introduce carnal excitement, emotionalism, fanaticism, confusion, immorality, and insanity, and on the whole they have grossly and woefully injured the true work of the Lord. Among other things it is at least partly responsible for the general indifference to the sound and right dispensational teaching of the Word of God. There is doubtless no warrant for such meetings and it goes without gainsaying that the masses are not healed by shadow-casting and handkerchief laying. Pentecost was a Jewish feat, whose association was exclusively with the Jewish calendar. Having been made one with the risen Lord of glory we have been blessed with all spiritual blessings and not with all the carnal and material blessings of Pentecost, Eph. 1:3.

This union is *free* and has no union fees. The rich, refined, religious, and virtuous church-members are no members of this union, if they are not hiding by faith in Christ. The God of all grace, I Pet. 5:10 has laid grace at the eternal entrance of this union. This grace came by Christ, who was full of grace, John 1:14, 17; Rom. 5:15; I Cor. 1:4; Eph. 1:6, 7; 2:4-8. This grace is even the source of God's election, Rom. 11:5 and of His calling, Gal. 1:15: justification, Rom. 3:24; Tit. 3:7; faith, Acts 18:27; forgiveness, Eph. 1:7; salvation, 2:5-8; consolation, II Thess. 2:16; hope, II Thess. 2:16. We are what we are by grace, and grace alone, I Cor. 15:10; II Cor. 1:12, and saints are exhorted to be strong in grace, II Tim. 2:1; Heb. 13:9; speak with grace. Eph. 4:29; Col. 4:6, and to grow in grace, II Pet. 3:18. Since grace is the unmerited and forfeited favor of God to guilty men, even the vilest lepers, leprous with sin, are welcome to this glorious union, if they only come just as they are to Christ.

Essentially and for the world this union is still *hidden.* The mystery of the Body of Christ was hidden from all ages and generations and hidden in God, Eph. 3:9;

Col. 1:26. No ancient worthy could ever know it, for the simple reason that it had not been revealed. In the last passage is found a threefold contract: *manifest* stands in contrast to *hid, now* to *past ages,* and *saints* to *former generations.* This mysterious, gracious and glorious union of the Head in heaven with the Body on earth was made known to Paul by the Spirit, Eph. 3:5, and therefore as a revealed truth it is now clearly stated in the Pauline Epistles; but worldly believers see and experience but a wee little bit of this oneness with the risen Savior, while the world knows positively nothing of this union. This is one reason why Lutheran and Reformed scholars have always called it the mystical union. It is the glory of God to conceal a thing. In the realm of nature He has buried gold, silver, and diamonds in the mud. "Full many a gem of purest ray serene" lies on the ocean bed. He hid His Son for four thousand years and then He hid Him for thirty years between the mountains of Nazareth, then He hid Him in the grave for three days, and the world has only seen Him as the Man of sorrows for three years. He is hid far above the heavens and so our life is hid with Him. Believers are now like Noah and his family in the ark with a raging world all around. We are like Joash concealed six years in the temple, and we are waiting for the day of public revelation.

This union shall find its glorious *climax* and culmination in the day of His appearing. When He appears, then also we shall appear with Him in glory, Col. 3:4.

The apostle combines the union also with the Hope of glory in Col. 1:27. The day of their public manifestation in glory with Him. Then there will be no spot or wrinkle or any such thing left on the believers. What is now a present truth in regard to their standing in Christ, will then be the revealed fact of their condition as well. All the blemishes of character, all the rimples and wrinkles will then be completely absent, and our bodies shall also be made like unto His own glorious body.

Finally, boundless *wealth* is a trait of this *incomparable* union with Christ. The first and last verses of Rom. 8 tell us that there is no condemnation, no *katacrimax,* and no separation, in Christ. There is no death in Him but the saintly dead are in Him, I Thess. 4:16; 4:14; Rev. 14:13. Babes are in Christ, I Cor. 3:1, as well as the strong. The whole man, body and soul is in Christ, II Cor. 12:2; I Cor. 1:30; Eph. 5:8. The whole new creation, Eph. 2:10; II Cor. 5:17; Gal. 6:15, all the believer's spiritual blessings, Eph. 1:3; life, Rom. 6:11, 23; 8:2; I Cor. 15:22; unity, Rom. 12:5; love, Rom. 8:39; liberty, Gal. 2:4; 5:1; help, Rom. 16:3, 9; steadfastness, Col. 2:5 ; local churches, Eph. 2:21; Gal. 1:22; 3:28; consolation, Phil. 2:1; the dead, I Thess. 4:16; hope, I Cor. 15:19, 22; bonds and imprisonment, Phil. 1:13; acceptance, Eph. 1:6; 2:13; joy, Phil. 4:4; peace, Phil. 4:2, 7; all-conquering strength, Phil. 4:13; fully supply, Phil. 4:19; righteousness, II Cor. 5:21 ; Phil. 3:9 ; sanctification, I Cor. 1:32; wisdom, I Cor. 1:32; redemption, I Cor. 1:32; completeness, Col. 2:10; the eternal purpose, Eph. 3:11; boldness, 3:12; promises, II Cor. 1:20; walk, Col. 2:6 ; triumph, II Cor. 2:14; the re-heading of all things, Eph. 1:10. All this and much more is in our wonderful Lord, and it indicates at the same time perfect commonality of life with all His own. Here alone is the perfect communism, since He took His own in full communion of goods. All His inexhaustible wealth is theirs. Here is also perfect interdependence, the believers sharing all His riches, and at the same time always

abounding in the work of the Lord. He took their place on Calvary, now they take His place in this world to do His work, I Cor. 15:58, not only church work, but *His* work.

This Union made after the Cross and Resurrection

This sacred union is never found in the Synoptics for the simple reason that it could not be made as long as Christ was a minister of the circumcision. John's Gospel occupies a unique place, since he wrote full thirty years after the others and had received the truth of this union from Paul. It was evidently written to supplement the first three narratives of Christ's ministry on earth among Israel. He uses the word *believe* 99 times and the word witness 129 times, all in reference to the Savior. It is the Gospel of witness. His purpose was to witness that Christ is God. The belief in Him, i.e., the faith that incorporates into Him is used several times. The unity between Him and the believers comes especially out in His prayer in chapter 17; because this prayer is made from the viewpoint of heaven and not of earth, and His death and resurrection are understood. In Acts faint allusions are made to this union in the crucified, risen Savior, 3:6; 4:2 *(through* is here *in*) 10, 12; 9:29; 10:48; 13:39; 16:18. All the expressions *in the name* do not mean that they said *in the name* or preached *in the name,* or on His authority, but according to an ancient Hebrewism, *in the being.* In Romans we get it clearer, 3:24, 25; 5:2, 9, 11, 17; 6:11,23 *(through* is *in);* 8:1,2,9,10,11,39; 9:1; 10:5; 12:4,5; 14:14,17; 15:17; 16:2, 3, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 22. In Acts and Romans we see a gradual progress in the revelation of this union with our Lord until we find it the clearest and fullest in the prison Epistles.

It has been said that this union is found just as well in Israel as among the Body of Christ, but nothing could be farther from the truth. It has been remarked that Israel is called several times the apple of God's eye, and that this would denote a perfect union; but this is no real union at all, but a metaphor to express the preciousness of Israel to God. We read also four times that the Psalmist takes refuge under His wings to signify that God has the tenderest maternal love for His people, but it is not at all expressive of this wondrous union. This is positively based upon His death and resurrection.

This Union reveals Christianity as a Remedial Scheme

It leads our thoughts to the very beginning when the Son created man *betzelem, in His image*. Sin came and man fell into the lap of Satan, where he is found today, if John is to be credited, 5:19. No prophet could put man back into His proper sphere; no priestly sacrifice, or prayer, or benediction, could accomplish this feat. No royal power was sufficient for this task. Even the great Prophet Himself in His ministry of circumcision for Israel never did fully undo the work of sin and never restored man in his proper sphere: in the Son; however His death and resurrection and the Spirit that went out from Him as well as from the Father, restored man in his Creator, the risen Lord. The Lord Jesus Christ does far more than undo the ravages of sin and the ruin of Satan, for the state of glory will be infinitely higher than the Paradisian state of integrity and righteousness, but this most assuredly includes that He will also neutralize and undo all the evil which sin has wrought,

and that He will put man in the glorious sphere which once He occupied. The Pauline monogram *in Christ,* which the early believers loved to place upon the graves of their departed in the Catacombs of Rome, reveals to us the interesting fact that *via* Calvary man is returned to his proper sphere.

Christian Mysticism and the Mystical Union

Mysticism in one form or another has always run like a golden thread throughout the history of the Church. Whenever a cold intellectualism tended to freeze theology and the hearts as well, mysticism swung the pendulum to the other extreme of the feelings which at one time manifested itself as enthusiasm and even mild fanaticism, at another time as Quietism. The fact is that *au fond* every true Bible believer is a mystic. Paul, John, and all the holy writers were true mystics, sweet communion as they had with God. Since the holy Canon was closed and God does not immediately reveal Himself in this age apart from the inspired Word, there is now no sound mysticism apart from the mystical union. All the Spinozan, Hegelian, and other philosophic and Pantheistic mysticism stands utterly condemned. But also a good deal of the so-called Christian Mysticism cannot stand the fiery test of the one real critic, the Word of God. The celebrated *"Imitation of Christ"* by Thomas A. Kempis has no eye whatsoever for this sacred oneness of the soul with God, but wants to imitate Jesus as the minister of circumcision, Rom. 15:8. The famed *"German Theology"* by Taulers suffers from the same defect. The sweet writings of Madame Guyon reveal a most saintly soul, but she had little or no concept of this real union with Christ. Arndt's mysticism is on the whole thoroughly spiritual, and unconsciously he drunk deep draughts from the fount of this holy union, but theologically it was not clear to him at all. The condemned *"Maxims of the Saints,"* by the godly Fenelon, are beautiful reading, but he also could not glory in an absolute oneness with the risen Lord of glory. The learned emotionalism of Schleiermacher assuredly reveals a mystic vein, but his mysticism is pantheistic and in every way false, because it runs counter to the Word and this sacred union with Christ.

William Law, celebrated author of the *"Serious Call" is* not a scriptural but a false mystic. Says he: "Poor sinner! Consider the treasure thou hast within thee! The Savior of the world, the Eternal Word of God, lies hid in thee, as a spark of the divine nature, which is to overcome sin, and death, and hell within thee; and generate again the life of God in thy soul. Turn to thy heart, and thy heart will find its Savior; its God within thyself." Our Lord Jesus described the heart as filled with thirteen abominations, but Law finds the Savior there. Fully fifty years ago Revell published a book by James M. Campbell on *"The Indwelling Christ."* Prof. A. B. Bruce of the Free Church College, Glasgow, wrote the Introduction and says that his opinion of the book is highly favorable. On p. 11 Campbell writes: "It is not Christ upon the cross, nor Christ within the Bible, nor Christ in heaven that saves, but Christ deeply hidden in the inmost spirit," truly a satanic lie. "Redemption is wrought out from within, not superimposed from without." This is not any better than Matthew Arnold's: "Far off lies in the lorn Syrian town, and on His grave with shining eyes the Syrian stars look down." The booklet *"The Practice of the Divine Presence,"* sold from Fundamentalist book stalls, is also unsound mysticism, and of

late a book has been issued with the fascinating title: *"Christ in You,"* which is filled with the deadliest poison. Satan counterfeits every sublime truth, and he would gladly exalt the indwelling Christ in order to give the death blow to the written Word, the cross and all the objective work of our Savior.

A Twofold Indwelling

Believers in Christ, must be carefully distinguished from Christ in the believers. The following differences may be noticed:

1 - The being in Christ is the necessary condition for the indwelling of Christ in the believer. The former must always be first a reality before the other can become a bright reality. Christ never dwells sanctifyingly in an unsaved person no matter how religious and churchy he may be.

2 - The former is universal to all believers, but this cannot be said of the latter. All the Ephesian believers were in Christ. They were chosen, accepted, redeemed, forgiven, in Christ, but Paul still agonized in prayer that Christ might dwell in their hearts by faith. Seeing the indwelling of the believer in Christ is basic to the other, the basis, the foundation for the building, had been laid, but the building was not yet reared upon that foundation.

3 - The *in Christ* denotes the standing which is immutable, whereas the *Christ in* you denotes the variable state. The former is indestructible and can never be lost under any condition, whereas the latter can be lost as we see in the Galatians, 4:19. Paul had gone through birth throes once in order that Christ might have *morphe,* form, figure, in them. The indwelling Christ became a heavenly reality within their hearts, but when Judaizing teachers bewitched them through the old serpent, 3:1, then that *morphe* of the indwelling Christ left them, and now Paul *palin odina, i.e.,* he is again, for the second time, in birth pangs to the end that Christ may be having a form in them.

4 - The *in Christ is* not in any form or manner dependent upon man. This is all of grace and not of works, lest any man should boast; whereas Christ in John 14:23 has imposed two conditions for the latter: a) love of Christ and b) an obedient keeping of His Word. When these two prerequisites are present, then He says: "We will come unto him and make our abide with him."

5 - The former makes a person a Christian, whilst the latter makes him a Christ-like Christian. We rejoice in the fact that there are many true believers in this land, but we cannot but mourn the fact that there are so few Christ-like Christians; but where are the Pauls?